Topic 13 — Gandhian Era (1915–1948)

Sources baked in: Spectrum, Bipan Chandra, NCERT Themes III, Ghatnachakra Purvalokan (Gandhi / Champaran–Kheda–Ahmedabad; Rowlatt–Jallianwala–Khilafat; NCM–Swaraj–Simon; Lahore–CDM–RTC–Poona), UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — chronology chains, pact/award years, Jallianwala reactions, Dandi/CDM, RTC, Poona Pact, Gaya-split and Constructive Programme heads **Last verified:** September 2026 gap audit — CCR confirmed/filled on South Africa, Champaran–Kheda–Ahmedabad, Rowlatt, Jallianwala, NCM, Khilafat, Vaikom, Simon boycott, CDM, Individual Satyagraha; identity-line glue fixed; Extra Drill present (no invented mega banks) **Current Affairs:** N/A (historical)

13.0 One Clear Picture — Phases of the Gandhian Era

Gandhi's leadership did **not** run as one continuous mass agitation. It moved through phases of **action, truce and construction**. Hold this map first; every later card plugs into it.

Phase	Years	Character	Key fact
Return & apprenticeship	1915–16	Learns India on Gokhale's advice before acting	Champaran, not 1915, is the first satyagraha
Local satyagrahas	1917–18	Peasant and labour disputes, not all-India	Champaran → Kheda → Ahmedabad
Rowlatt climate	1919	All-India protest meets Punjab repression	Rowlatt Act → Jallianwala Bagh
Mass phase I	1920–22	First all-India boycott (बहिष्कार); Khilafat joins in	Calcutta → Nagpur → Chauri Chaura withdrawal
Council-entry interlude	1922–29	Gaya split; Swarajists work the councils; Simon/Nehru Report debated	Gaya 1922 → Swaraj Party 1923 → Simon 1927
Independence pledge	1929–30	Purna Swaraj declared; ultimatum sent; salt march begins	Lahore Dec 1929 → Eleven Points Jan 1930 → Dandi Mar 1930
Truce and pacts	1931–34	Irwin pact, RTCs, Communal Award, Poona Pact, CDM withdrawn	Mar 1931 → Sep 1932 → Apr 1934
Constructive decade	1934–39	Gandhi steps back from direct command; builds village-level programme	Khadi, Harijan (हरिजन) work, Nai Talim 1937
Bridge to World War II	1940	Symbolic protest replaces mass movement during wartime	August Offer rejected → Individual Satyagraha

> **Logic:** This chapter's story does not stop in 1934 or 1940 — Cripps (1942), Quit India (1942) and the endgame (1945–47) are the direct continuation, taught in full in **Topic 14**.

13.1 Indian National Movement Chronology (Gandhian phase)

Year	Event
1915	Gandhi returns; Ferozeshah Mehta dies
1917	Champaran
1918	Kheda; Ahmedabad mill strike
1919	Rowlatt; Jallianwala (13 Apr); Hunter Committee inquiry
1920–22	Khilafat + Non-Cooperation; Chauri Chaura Feb 1922
1922	Gaya session; No-changers vs Pro-changers split (Dec)
1923	Swaraj Party founded (Jan)
1927	Simon Commission appointed
1928	Nehru Report; Simon in India; Lajpat Rai (राई) lathi-charge
1929	Sharda Act; Lahore Purna Swaraj (Dec)
1930	Eleven Points (Jan); 26 Jan Independence Day; Dandi; CDM; 1st RTC (Congress absent)
1931	Gandhi–Irwin (5 Mar); Karachi session; 2nd RTC
1932	Communal Award (16 Aug); Poona Pact (24 Sep); 3rd RTC
1934	CDM withdrawn
1937	Wardha Education Conference — Nai Talim adopted
1940	August Offer (8 Aug); Individual Satyagraha (Oct)
1942+	Cripps, Quit India, Cabinet Mission (कैबिनेट मिशन) — later phase, full cards in **Topic 14**

> **Logic:** Drill Gandhi-era chronology until automatic: Simon → Nehru Report → Sharda Act → Dandi → Gandhi–Irwin Pact → CDM end → Poona Pact. Cripps, Wavell and Cabinet Mission belong to Topic 14, but this chapter's own 1940 bridge (August Offer, Individual Satyagraha) must be scored here, not skipped.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q7

Consider the following events and arrange them in correct chronological order.

1. Poona Pact
2. End of Civil Disobedience Movement

3. Gandhi-Irwin Pact
4. Second Round Table Conference

A. 3, 4, 2, 1

B. 4, 3, 1, 2

C. 4, 3, 2, 1

D. 3, 4, 1, 2

Show answer

Ans: D — Mar 1931 → Sep–Dec 1931 → Sep 1932 → Apr 1934.

13.1A Gandhi — early life and return

Born: 2 October 1869, **Porbandar**, Gujarat **Father: Karamchand Gandhi (Kaba Gandhi)** — Diwan of **Porbandar, Rajkot and Wankaner Marriage: Kasturba** at age **13 College tag: Samaldas College, Bhavnagar Law: Inner Temple**, London

- Schooling began at Porbandar and continued at **Rajkot** after his father's transfer.
- In **1893**, aged **24**, he went to **Durban** for the case of Gujarati trader **Dada Abdullah**.
- He stayed in South Africa about **21 years** and returned in **January 1915**.
- His first Congress appearance was the **Calcutta session, 1901** (President **Dinshaw Wacha**), where an Africa resolution of his was taken up.
- **Gopal Krishna (कृष्णा) Gokhale** is his political guru. Gokhale told him to spend the first year in India with **ears open and mouth shut**.
- In **1915** he founded **Satyagraha Ashram** at Ahmedabad (Kocharab); on **17 June 1917** it moved to the **Sabarmati** (साबरमती) bank and became known as Sabarmati Ashram (साबरमती).

> **Logic:** Birth **Porbandar 1869**. Return **1915**. First Indian satyagraha still **Champaran 1917**.

13.2 Gandhi in South Africa

Years: 1893–1915 (about **21 years**) **Spark:** Pietermaritzburg train insult (**1893**) **Organisation: Natal Indian Congress (1894) Press:** ***Indian Opinion*** (English, Gujarati, Hindi, Tamil) **Ashrams: Phoenix Settlement (1904**, near Durban — his **oldest**); **Tolstoy Farm (1910)** with Kallenbach

Cause

- White colonial governments in Natal and the Transvaal imposed racial registration, immigration curbs and a **£3** poll tax on Indians, treating them as a permanent underclass rather than as British subjects with equal rights.

- The Pietermaritzburg train incident showed Gandhi that legal status alone would not protect Indians without organised, moral resistance.

Course

- Gandhi founded the **Natal Indian Congress (1894)** and ran ***Indian Opinion*** to organise the community.
- From **1906** he led a long **satyagraha** against the Asiatic Registration Act, immigration rules and the £3 tax — courting arrest, burning registration certificates, and building disciplined non-violent cadres.
- **Phoenix (1904)** and later **Tolstoy Farm (1910)** trained volunteers in simple living and non-violent discipline. He practised **Seva Dharma** (hospital/compounder service) and applied **trusteeship** in his Johannesburg law firm (**1903–10**).
- ***Hind Swaraj*** **(1909)** was written on the ship voyage and stated his critique of modern civilisation and his idea of true swaraj.

Result

- The **Indian Relief Act, 1914** ended this South African phase by easing the worst of the registration and tax grievances.
- Gandhi returned to India in **January 1915**, carrying satyagraha as a tested method. He toured for a year on **Gokhale's** advice and later made **Sabarmati** his Indian ashram base.
- First Indian satyagraha is still **Champaran 1917**, not the 1915 return.

> **Logic:** South Africa = the laboratory of satyagraha. First Indian satyagraha is **Champaran 1917**, not 1915.

13.3 Gandhian Ideology

- **Satyagraha** is truth-force. The opponent is to be converted, not crushed. It is not cowardly submission.
- **Ahimsa** is non-violence as a creed, including in means.
- **Swaraj** (स्वराज) is self-rule of the self and of the nation. It is not a brown copy of English rule (*Hind Swaraj*).
- **Sarvodaya** and **trusteeship** mean welfare of all. Wealth is held in trust. Class war is not the first method.
- **Swadeshi** (स्वदेशी), the **charkha** (चरखा), bread labour and village reconstruction make up the **constructive programme**.
- **Hindu–Muslim unity** and **removal of untouchability** were political, not optional piety.
- Twin principles of his **Ram Rajya** are **truth and non-violence**. Non-violence is the **means**; truth is the **end**.
- He stressed **practical idealism**. Notes often tag him with **philosophical anarchism** (ideal of a moral, near-stateless order) while still working through politics for public welfare.

- He told **Louis Fischer** he was a **true socialist**, and that his socialism meant **Sarvodaya** (progress of all).
- In satyagraha practice, **fasting** is the early/inner weapon; **strike** is often keyed as the **last** step. The aim is to **change the opponent's heart**, not to defeat him.
- **Wrong means never take us to right ends** — means and ends are two sides of one coin (मुद्रा).
- For family planning he preferred **self-control**. Persistence of **poverty** he called among the cruellest forms of violence.
- Secular influences: **Ruskin** (*Unto This Last* — good of the individual in the good of all), **Thoreau** (civil disobedience), **Tolstoy** (*The Kingdom of God Is Within You*).
- Politics for him meant **public welfare**, with **decentralisation** to village panchayats. Ideal politics mixes **ethics, religion and humanity** — not naked **authority**.
- Ends and means must match. That is why he withdrew NCM after **Chauri Chaura**.

> **Logic:** Satyagraha ≠ Extremism (boycott politics) ≠ revolutionary (क्रांतिकारी) bombs.

13.4 Champaran, Kheda and Ahmedabad Mill Strike

Champaran (1917)

Place: Champaran, Bihar **Issue:** *Tinkathia* — peasants forced to plant indigo on **3/20** of the holding **Invite: Raj Kumar Shukla** brought Gandhi

Cause

- Under the *tinkathia* system, European planters forced tenant farmers to grow indigo on a fixed share of their land at rates the planters themselves fixed, regardless of market price or the farmer's own needs.
- **Raj Kumar Shukla**, a local peasant, persuaded Gandhi to see the distress for himself.

Course

- Gandhi began his **first satyagraha in India** by investigating conditions on the ground. He was ordered to leave the district, refused to obey, and courted arrest; the order was withdrawn under pressure.
- His aides included **Rajendra Prasad**, **J.B. Kripalani**, **Mahadev Desai (आमिल)**, **C.F. Andrews**, **Anugrah Narayan Sinha**, **Brajkishore Prasad** and others.
- **Batak Mian**, a cook at a planter's house, warned Gandhi of poisoned milk and saved his life.
- The government set up the **Champaran Agrarian Enquiry Committee**; Gandhi sat on it. Planters agreed to refund a share (often remembered as **25%**) of illegal exactions.
- **Rabindranath Tagore** is remembered as first giving him the title **Mahatma** in this season. **N.G. Ranga** opposed Gandhi's Champaran line.

Result

- The government inquiry broke the *tinkathia* system, and the **Champaran Agrarian Act** followed in **1918**, giving peasants relief from forced indigo cultivation.
- Do **not** merge this with the **Indigo Revolt of 1859–60**. That was Bengal, under the Biswas brothers.

> **Logic:** Champaran **1917** = Gandhi + tinkathia + Bihar.

Kheda (1918)

Place: Kheda, Gujarat **Issue:** crop failure; demand for **revenue remission Leaders:** Gandhi, **Vallabhbhai Patel**, Indulal Yagnik

Cause

- Successive crop failures had left Kheda's peasants unable to pay full land revenue, but the government still insisted on collecting the full assessed amount.

Course

- Gandhi and Patel organised a **no-revenue satyagraha**: peasants refused to pay until the government agreed to relief, while the organisers built village-level discipline to sustain the refusal.

Result

- The government granted **partial remission** of the revenue demand.
- This satyagraha marked the start of Patel's rural organisational base in Gujarat; **Bardoli (बारडोली) 1928** (बारडोली) is the later, bigger Patel card.

Ahmedabad Mill Strike (1918)

Cause

- Mill workers had received a **plague bonus** during a plague outbreak; once the plague passed, owners wanted to withdraw it even as prices kept rising, leaving workers demanding a permanent wage increase instead.

Course

- **Anasuya Sarabhai** invited Gandhi to mediate between the workers and the mill-owners, one of whom was her own brother, **Ambalal Sarabhai**.
- When talks stalled, Gandhi undertook his **first hunger strike in India** to press for a settlement while keeping the workers disciplined and non-violent.

Result

- The strike ended in a settlement generally remembered as around a **35%** wage rise.

> **Logic:** 1917 Champaran → 1918 Kheda and Ahmedabad. Three early satyagrahas before Rowlatt.

13.4A Gandhi's circle — titles, associates and late facts

- **Subhas Chandra Bose** (सुभाष चंद्र बोस) first called Gandhi **Father of the Nation** on **Azad Hind Radio** (**July 1944**), seeking blessings for the final struggle.
- **C.F. Andrews**, a St Stephen's professor close to Tagore, Gokhale and Gandhi, lived at Phoenix; Gandhi named him **Dinbandhu**. Andrews was AITUC (एटक) president in **1925** and **1927** and accompanied Gandhi to the Round Table Conference.
- **Jamnalal Bajaj** (Wardha industrialist, Congress treasurer) was a lifelong associate — Gandhi's "fifth son" tag. He renounced **Rai Bahadur**, backed village industry and khadi, and was jailed in the **Nagpur Flag Satyagraha (1923)** and again in **1930**.
- **Pyarelal Nayyar** was Gandhi's secretary in the **Noakhali** period; his sister **Sushila Nayyar** was Gandhi's personal doctor. Pyarelal also figured in the Dandi March organisation.
- Gandhi called **Yerawada** jail a **Mandir**. **Mountbatten** paid tribute to him as a **one-man boundary force** for calming Bengal when Punjab burned.
- In **1934** Gandhi resigned formal Congress membership; at Independence he was **not** a Congress office-bearer, though his guidance still shaped politics.
- After the assassination (**30 January 1948**, **Nathuram Godse**), Nehru said **"the light has gone out of our lives."**

> **Logic:** Father of the Nation = **Bose's phrase**. Mahatma = **Tagore's Champaran-era tag**. Dinbandhu = **Andrews**.

13.5 Rowlatt Act (1919)

Act: Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act, **1919 Nickname: Black Act Viceroy:** Chelmsford

Cause

- Wartime emergency powers had let the government detain suspects without trial. The British wanted to keep similar powers in peacetime to deal with revolutionary terrorism, especially in Punjab and Bengal.

Course

- The **Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act, 1919** allowed detention **without trial**, with no real right of appeal.
- Popular tag: **No Vakil, No Appeal, No Daleel**. Viceroy = **Chelmsford**. Rowlatt Satyagraha is Gandhi's first **all-India** venture (cities-heavy).
- Gandhi called an all-India **hartal / satyagraha on 6 April 1919** to protest the "Black Act".
- Punjab responded most strongly; the Rowlatt protest became the direct climate leading into **Jallianwala Bagh** (जलियांवाला बाग).

Result

- The Act was still pushed through despite the protest, but the agitation showed Gandhi's power to call an all-India hartal for the first time.

- Gandhi suspended the wider satyagraha after violence broke out in several cities, an early sign of the same discipline he later enforced after Chauri Chaura.
- The Act is **not** the 1919 GOI Act (Montagu–Chelmsford dyarchy) — two separate 1919 laws.

> **Logic:** Rowlatt **1919** = no-trial detention. GOI Act 1919 = dyarchy. Two different 1919s.

13.6 Jallianwala Bagh (13 April 1919)

Place: Amritsar, Punjab **Day:** Baisakhi (बैसाखी), **13 April 1919 Officer:** Brigadier **Reginald Dyer Lt Governor: Michael O'Dwyer**

Cause

- The Rowlatt protest of April 1919 had already inflamed Punjab. Local leaders were arrested and public meetings banned, but a crowd still gathered at Jallianwala Bagh, partly to protest and partly for a normal Baisakhi fair.

Course

- Brigadier **Reginald Dyer** marched troops into the walled garden and ordered them to fire on the unarmed crowd without adequate warning and with no escape route open. Official and unofficial counts put the dead in the hundreds.
- **Martial law** followed across Punjab under Lt Governor **Michael O'Dwyer**, including the humiliating **crawling order** imposed on a street where an Englishwoman had been attacked.

Result

- The **Hunter Committee (1919)**, chaired by Lord **William Hunter**, inquired into the firing and the wider Punjab disturbances. It censured Dyer for excessive force but did **not** recommend (सिफारिश) his prosecution; Dyer instead became a hero to many in Britain through the Morning Post fund.
- **Rabindranath Tagore returned his knighthood** in protest; **Chettur Sankaran Nair** resigned from the **Viceroy's Executive Council** (not the knighthood response). He is **not** the knighthood answer.
- Gandhi returned his **Kaiser-i-Hind** medal. Jallianwala, together with the Khilafat grievance, pushed him toward launching Non-Cooperation.
- Arrested local leaders **Dr Saifuddin Kitchlew** and **Dr Satyapal** were the immediate protest context of the Bagh gathering.
- **Montagu** called the massacre **Preventive Murder**. Gandhi drafted the **Congress inquiry** report on the massacre.
- **Udham Singh** later killed **Michael O'Dwyer** in London (**1940**).
- Do **not** confuse the 1919 inquiry with the **Hunter Commission (Indian Education Commission), 1882**, chaired by **W.W. Hunter**, which reviewed education under Ripon (रिपन) — same surname, sixty years apart, unrelated subjects.

> **Logic:** Tagore = **knighthood**. Sankaran Nair = **Executive Council resignation**. Hunter Committee = **1919 firing inquiry**, not the 1882 education body.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q83

Who returned the 'Knighthood' title to the British Government in reaction against the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre?

A. Md. Ali Jinnah

B. Rabindranath Tagore

C. Rameshwar Singh

D. Shankaran Nair

Show answer

Ans: B

[!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q135)**: Sir Chettur Sankaran Nair resigned from the Viceroy's Executive Council in direct protest against the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre and military atrocities in Punjab.

13.7 Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–22)

Launch climate: Khilafat + Punjab wrongs + Rowlatt **Calcutta Special Session: September 1920** (Lajpat Rai president) — NCM adopted **Nagpur Session: December 1920** — programme completed; Congress constitution recast

Cause

- Jallianwala Bagh, the wider Punjab repression, and the Khilafat grievance together convinced Gandhi that cooperating with a government capable of such acts was itself immoral.
- He argued that British rule survived only because Indians cooperated with its institutions, so mass, disciplined non-cooperation could paralyse it without violence.

Course

- The **Calcutta Special Session (September 1920)**, with **Lajpat Rai** presiding, adopted Non-Cooperation; the **Nagpur Session (December 1920)** completed the programme and recast the Congress constitution for mass membership.
- Methods included surrender of titles, and boycott of schools, courts, councils and foreign cloth. **Khadi** (खादी) and national schools were the constructive side. The **Tilak Swaraj Fund** financed the work; **Tilak** (तिलक) himself died on **1 August 1920**, just as the movement opened.
- Students, lawyers and peasants joined in large numbers across the country; **Periyar** (पेरियार) took part in NCM in the south before leaving Congress in **1925**.
- On **5 February 1922** at **Chauri Chaura** in **Gorakhpur district, UP**, a crowd burnt a police station and policemen died.

Result

- After Chauri Chaura, Gandhi withdrew NCM at **Bardoli (12 February 1922)**.
- **Dr Moonje** moved a vote of censure against the withdrawal at the Delhi AICC (**24 February 1922**).
- **Tagore** criticised the burning of foreign cloth as **ruthless / unwise waste** and urged constructive work.
- Gandhi returned **Kaiser-i-Hind**; **Jamnalal Bajaj** returned **Rai Bahadur**.
- National schools of the wave include **Gujarat Vidyapeeth (1920)** and **Kashi (काशी) Vidyapeeth (1921)**; Jamia Millia also belongs to this climate.
- He was jailed, and used the time to write *My Experiments with Truth*.
- **Belgaum 1924** later became his **only** Congress presidentship, and NCM's abrupt end fed directly into the Gaya split over what Congress should do next (13.9).

> **Logic:** NCM withdrawn after **Chauri Chaura 1922**, not after Jallianwala. UP geography = **Gorakhpur** (गोरखपुर).

13.8 Khilafat Movement

Issue: protect the **Ottoman Caliph** after World War I **Leaders: Mohammad Ali, Shaukat Ali**, Maulana Azad, Hasrat Mohani, Dr Ansari **Allied with Congress: 1920–22**

Cause

- The **Treaty of Sèvres** after World War I threatened to dismantle the Ottoman Caliphate, which many Indian Muslims saw as the symbolic head of their faith — a religious grievance running alongside Congress's political grievances of the same years.

Course

- Leaders such as **Mohammad Ali, Shaukat Ali**, Maulana Azad, Hasrat Mohani and Dr Ansari built a mass Khilafat campaign from **1919**. Gandhi joined it to the **Non-Cooperation Movement in 1920**, so Hindus and Muslims campaigned together under one programme of boycott and non-cooperation.
- Gandhi was elected President of the All-India Khilafat Conference at **Delhi (Nov 1919)**. He called Khilafat a **golden opportunity** for Hindu–Muslim unity.
- **Hakim Ajmal Khan** renounced the title **Haziq-ul-Mulk**. **Jinnah** opposed mixing Khilafat religion with Congress politics and warned against fanaticism.
- **Madan Mohan Malaviya (मालवीय)** did not support the Khilafat line.
- Some Muslims attempted **Hijrat** (migration) to Afghanistan in protest. **Moplah 1921** (मोपला) exploded in this same charged climate in Malabar, though it is **not** the same event as Khilafat.

Result

- The joint Hindu–Muslim front held together through 1922, but it lost its cause when **Turkey itself abolished the Caliphate in 1924**, and the movement dissolved without leaving a lasting communal alliance behind.

> **Logic:** Khilafat + NCM = **1920–22 joint**. Khilafat starts **after** Home Rule (होम रूल) (1916) and Jallianwala (1919) in the 2023 four-event set.

13.9 Gaya Session, No-changers vs Pro-changers, and the Swaraj Party (1922–23)

Gaya Session: Indian National Congress, **December 1922 President: C.R. Das** (favoured council entry; resigned when the session voted him down)

- After Chauri Chaura, Congress had to decide what to do with the machinery of boycott once mass agitation had stopped.
- At Gaya, the party split into two camps over entering the legislative councils created under the **Government of India Act, 1919**.

No-changers

- Wanted to **stay out of the councils** and continue constructive, grassroots work: khadi, national schools, temperance, Hindu–Muslim unity.
- Led by **Gandhi** (गांधी), **Rajendra Prasad**, **C. Rajagopalachari (Rajaji (राजाजी))** and **Vallabhbhai Patel**.
- Their argument: entering the councils would blunt the boycott and tie Congress to a legislature it did not control.

Pro-changers / Swarajists

- Wanted to enter the councils and **obstruct government business from within** — turning "responsive cooperation" into deliberate obstruction.
- Led by **C.R. Das** and **Motilal Nehru**, who founded the **Swaraj Party at Allahabad in January 1923**.
- **C.R. Das** is remembered as **Deshbandhu**. He wanted Swaraj **for the masses, not only the classes**.
- **Rajagopalachari**, Rajendra Prasad and Patel were **No-changers**, not Swaraj Party founders.
- Swarajists contested the **1923 council elections** and won enough seats to disrupt budgets and bills.
- **Vithalbhai Patel** became the first Indian President of the Central Legislative Assembly with Swarajist backing.
- The party worked **inside Congress**, not as a permanent breakaway.
- **C.R. Das died in 1925**; Motilal's energy also declined, and the party faded through the late 1920s.
- Do **not** confuse Swarajists with the **Congress Socialist Party (1934)** or with the **Swarajya (स्वराज्य) Sabha (सभा)**, the Home Rule League renamed in **1920**.

> **Logic:** Gaya **December 1922** = the split. Swaraj Party **January 1923** = the organised council-entry group. No-changers ≠ Pro-changers; C.R. Das was a **Pro-changer**, not a No-changer.

13.10 Simon Commission (1927)

Appointed: November 1927 (came to India **1928**) **Chairman:** Sir **John Simon Why hated: all-white** — no Indian member; tasked to review the **1919** Act

Cause

- The British appointed an all-white Statutory Commission under **John Simon** to review the working of the **Government of India Act, 1919**, without a single Indian member on the panel.
- Indian opinion read this as a denial of the right of Indians to shape their own constitutional future.

Course

- Congress and most parties boycotted the Commission with the slogan **Simon Go Back**. Hartals, black flags and processions met the Commission wherever it travelled in **1928**.
- At Lahore in **October 1928**, **Lala Lajpat Rai** (लाला लाजपत राय) was lathi-charged while leading a protest; he died on **17 November 1928**. The HSRA's Saunders murder is the revolutionary sequel to that outrage.
- Parallel to the boycott, Indian leaders drafted their own constitutional reply — the **Nehru Report (1928)**.

Result

- The boycott destroyed any claim that an all-white review could settle India's future. Simon's report fed the **Round Table Conference** process, while the **Nehru Report** became the Indian alternative draft.
- Chronology lock: **Simon** → **Nehru Report** → **Sharda Act** → **Dandi**.

> **Logic:** Simon **appointed 1927**, in India **1928**. Chronology: Simon → Nehru Report → Sharda Act → Dandi.

13.11 Nehru Report (1928)

Author-committee: Motilal Nehru (not Jawaharlal) **Year: 1928 Demand: Dominion Status**; fundamental rights; joint electorates with reserved seats for Muslims (not separate electorates as a first principle)

- It was an all-parties reply to "put up a constitution."
- The draft demanded **dominion status**, **joint electorates** with minority seats, and a fundamental-rights list — **not** complete independence.
- Jinnah walked away. His **Fourteen Points (1929)** are the Muslim League counter.
- **Jawaharlal Nehru** (जवाहरलाल नेहरू) and **Subhas Bose** founded the **Independence for India League (1928)** to push **Purna Swaraj** against the dominion compromise.
- Dominion status was still the Congress goal until **Lahore 1929** switched to **Purna Swaraj**.
- **Sharda (Child Marriage Restraint) Act, 1929** sits between Nehru Report (**1928**) and Dandi (**1930**).

> **Logic:** Nehru Report = **Motilal 1928 Dominion**. Purna Swaraj = **Jawaharlal / Lahore 1929**. Independence League = **Nehru–Bose 1928**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q28

Consider the following events and arrange them into chronological order:

I. Sharda Act II. Nehru Report III. Constitution of Simon Commission IV. Dandi March

A. III, II, I and IV

B. I, II, III and IV

C. IV, III, II and I

D. I, IV, II and III

Show answer

Ans: A — 1927 → 1928 → 1929 → 1930.

13.12 Lahore Session and Purna Swaraj

Session: Lahore, **December 1929 President: Jawaharlal Nehru Resolution: Purna Swaraj** (complete independence) **Independence Day: 26 January 1930** (pledge)

- **Hasrat Mohani** had already asked Ahmedabad Congress (**1921**, session chaired for jailed **C.R. Das** by **Hakim Ajmal Khan**) to define Swaraj as complete independence.
- **Calcutta Congress (1928)** gave Britain an ultimatum: accept the **Nehru Report** within a year or face mass struggle.
- Irwin's vague dominion hint (**October 1929**) did not satisfy Congress, so **Lahore (Dec 1929)** under **Jawaharlal Nehru** (his first Congress presidency (प्रेसीडेंसी)) adopted **Purna Swaraj**.
- At midnight **31 December 1929** Nehru hoisted the tricolour on the **Ravi** (रावी). The CWC (केंद्रीय जल आयोग) (**2 January 1930**) fixed **26 January 1930** as **Purna Swaraj Day** (kept till 1947; Republic Day later took the date).
- Lahore also rejected dominion compromise, saw no gain in RTCs, redefined Swaraj as complete independence, and authorised CDM when Congress chose.
- Gandhi followed up with an ultimatum to Irwin the next month — his **Eleven Points**, taught in full next.
- They were ignored. **Dandi** (दांडी) followed.

> **Logic:** Purna Swaraj = **Lahore 1929**, not 1928 Nehru Report. 26 Jan 1930 = pledge day.

13.13 Gandhi's Eleven Points (January 1930)

Sent to: Viceroy **Irwin When: January 1930**, weeks before Dandi **Nature:** a mixed list of political and economic demands, offered as an alternative to launching civil disobedience

- Gandhi told Irwin that Congress would call off the coming mass movement if these eleven demands were met. The demands were: 1. Reduce land revenue by **50%**, and bring it under legislative control. 2. Cut military expenditure by at least **50%**. 3. Enforce **total prohibition**. 4. Abolish the **salt tax** and the government salt monopoly. 5. Reduce the **rupee–sterling exchange ratio**, seen as biased against Indian trade (पण्याध्यक्ष). 6. Give **protective tariffs** to Indian textiles against foreign cloth. 7. Reserve **coastal shipping** for Indians. 8. Cut the salaries of **higher civil servants** by half. 9. Abolish the **Criminal Investigation Department (CID)**, or place it under popular control. 10. Issue **firearms licences for self-defence**, subject to popular control. 11. Release **political prisoners** not convicted of violence, and withdraw pending prosecutions against them.
- Irwin gave no substantive reply.
- The rejection gave Congress the moral ground to launch the **Civil Disobedience Movement**, opening with the **salt** demand because it touched every household.
- The Eleven Points are **not** the same as Jinnah's **Fourteen Points (1929)** — those were the Muslim League's constitutional counter-demands to the Nehru Report, not an ultimatum to the Viceroy.

> **Logic:** Eleven Points = **Gandhi to Irwin, January 1930**. Fourteen Points = **Jinnah, 1929**, a different document to a different audience.

13.14 Civil Disobedience Movement and Dandi March

Dandi March: 12 March – 6 April 1930 From: Sabarmati Ashram **To:** Dandi (Navsari / coastal Gujarat) **Walkers:** 78 at the start; 24 days; 241 miles (memory)

Cause

- Lahore 1929 had committed Congress to **Purna Swaraj**, and Gandhi's **Eleven Points** ultimatum to Irwin (13.13) had gone unanswered, leaving civil disobedience as the only option left.
- Gandhi chose the **salt tax** as the opening symbol because it touched every household, rich or poor, and made the injustice of colonial taxation immediately visible.

Course

- Gandhi and 78 followers walked from **Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi**, **12 March – 6 April 1930**, over 24 days and about 241 miles, and broke the **salt law** on **6 April 1930** by making salt from sea water.
- CDM then widened into defiance of forest laws, a no-tax campaign, boycott of foreign cloth and liquor, and women's picketing of shops selling foreign goods.
- The **Vedaranyam March** in Tamil Nadu (नाडु), led by **C. Rajagopalachari**, repeated the salt symbol in the south.
- Subhas Bose likened the Dandi March to Napoleon's march from **Elba to Paris**. At Dandi (**5 April**) Gandhi asked for "**world sympathy in this battle of Right against Might**."

- After Gandhi's arrest (**5 May 1930**, Yeravada), **Abbas Tyabji** led, then **Sarojini Naidu** led the **Dharasana** raid; American journalist **Webb Miller** reported the beating at Dharasana.
- **Khudai Khidmatgars (Red Shirts)** under **Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan** carried NWFP into CDM. **Chandra Singh Garhwali**'s Garhwal (गढ़वाल) riflemen refused to fire on an unarmed crowd at **Peshawar**.
- Naga (नागा) leader **Gaidinliu**'s **Jiatrang** stream in Manipur is a tribal (आदिवासी) CDM-side tag. After CDM's ebb Gandhi shifted weight to constructive / Harijan work.

Result

- Congress boycotted the **1st RTC (1930)** since CDM was still on.
- CDM paused after the **Gandhi–Irwin Pact, March 1931**, resumed after the 2nd RTC failed to satisfy Congress, and was finally **withdrawn about April 1934** once repression and the Communal Award/Poona Pact years had drained its momentum.

> **Logic:** Dandi **1930** launches CDM. End of CDM is **1934**, after Poona Pact **1932**.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q82)**: Webb Miller was the American journalist who reported on the heroic, peaceful satyagrahis brutally beaten by police during the Dharsana Salt Works raid in May 1930.

13.15 Round Table Conferences

RTC	When	Congress
1st	Nov 1930 – Jan 1931	**Absent** (CDM on)
2nd	Sep – Dec 1931	**Gandhi sole Congress representative**
3rd	Nov – Dec 1932	**Absent** (Gandhi in jail)

- Held in **London** after Simon. Congress **boycotted the 1st**; **K.T. Paul** is a Christian-representative tag for that session (chaired climate: Ramsay MacDonald).
- At the **2nd RTC** Gandhi was Congress's **sole** official representative (travelled on **S.S. Rajputana**, stayed at **Kingsley Hall**). **Sarojini Naidu**, **Madan Mohan Malaviya** and **Annie Besant (बेसेंट)** also attended; **Nehru** (नेहरू) and **Rajendra Prasad** did not.
- Conference failed mainly on **communal** deadlock; **Ambedkar** (अम्बेडकर) pressed separate electorates for Depressed Classes — the road to the Communal Award.
- **Ambedkar** (and often **Tej (उष्णकटिबंधीय पूर्वी जेट) Bahadur Sapru**) attended **all three** RTCs. Congress skipped the **3rd** too.

> **Logic:** Gandhi attended **only the 2nd** RTC. Prasad is the 2020 odd man out.

[!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q24)**: Dr. Rajendra Prasad did NOT attend the Second Round Table Conference; Mahatma Gandhi attended as sole Congress representative, accompanied by Sarojini Naidu, Madan Mohan Malaviya, and C.F. Andrews.

13.16 Gandhi–Irwin Pact and Karachi Session

Gandhi–Irwin / Delhi Pact: 5 March 1931 Viceroy: Lord Irwin

- Mediators **Tej Bahadur Sapru** and **M.R. Jayakar** helped open talks. **Sarojini Naidu** called Gandhi and Irwin the **Two Mahatmas**.
- Congress to **suspend CDM**. Government to release non-violent political prisoners, allow peaceful picketing, and permit coastal salt-making. Gandhi to attend the **2nd RTC**.
- Bhagat Singh (भगत सिंह)'s hanging (**23 March 1931**) came **after** the pact and poisoned the mood. Irwin's biographer **Alan Campbell Johnson** called Gandhi's gains **consolation prizes**.
- **Karachi Congress (29–31 March 1931)**, President **Vallabhbhai Patel**, endorsed the pact and for the first time adopted **Fundamental Rights** (मौलिक अधिकार) and a **National Economic Programme** (drafted by **Nehru** with **M.N. Roy**'s help).
- Bose later called Karachi the **pinnacle of Gandhi's popularity**. Facing hostility after the hangings, Gandhi said Gandhi may die but **Gandhism** cannot.

Logic: Gandhi–Irwin **March 1931** comes **before** 2nd RTC. Karachi **1931** = FR resolution.

13.17 Communal Award and Poona Pact

Communal Award: 16 August 1932, **Ramsay MacDonald Poona Pact: 24 September 1932**, Yeravada (Gandhi–Ambedkar; Malaviya among signatories)

- The Award gave **separate electorates** to Depressed Classes (and continued them for Muslims, Sikhs, etc.).
- Gandhi fasted unto death in **Yeravada jail**. He accepted reserved seats but not separate electorates for Harijans.
- Gandhi did **not** personally sign the text; **Madan Mohan Malaviya** (Hindu side) and **Ambedkar** (Depressed Classes) headed the signatories.
- The **Poona Pact** (पूना पैक्ट) kept **joint electorates** with **reserved seats**. Provincial seats rose from about **71 to 148** (some books say 147); about **18%** of central general seats is the usual note.
- After the Pact Gandhi founded the **All India Anti-Untouchability League**, later **Harijan Sevak Sangh**; first President **G.D. Birla**. His weekly ***Harijan*** *(हरिजन)* (1933) carried the campaign.
- Ambedkar's sharp line on Gandhi: Mahatmas raise **dust but not the level** (**fleeting phantoms** remark, 1931 conversation).
- The **Communal Award** was announced on **16 August 1932**, not 1933.
- Award ≠ Poona Pact. Award = separate electorates. Pact = reserved seats.

> **Logic:** Award **16 Aug 1932**. Pact **24 Sep 1932**. Not 1933.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q19

Which of the following is NOT correctly matched? (Event) (Year)

A. Indian Navy Act 1927

B. Civil Disobedience 1930 Movement

C. Second Round Table 1931 Conference

D. The Communal Award 1933

Show answer

Ans: D — Communal Award = **1932**.

13.18 Gandhi's Constructive Programme

Gandhi built this list through the 1920s–30s and stated it most fully in a **1941 pamphlet**: concrete, everyday nation-building tasks for Congress workers to do **between** mass movements. It is what the **No-changers** did after 1922, and what filled the constructive decade of 1934–39.

- **Communal unity** — daily contact and trust-building between Hindus, Muslims, Sikhs, Christians and Parsis, not just a political alliance at the top.
- **Removal of untouchability** — temple entry (मंदिर प्रवेश), well access and social mixing for Harijans. His paper ***Harijan*** carried this campaign. The **Vaikom Satyagraha (1924–25)** in Travancore is the stock example (full CCR card just below).
- **Prohibition** (प्रतिषेध) — a campaign against liquor and drugs, treated as both a moral and an economic reform.
- **Khadi and hand-spinning** — the charkha as the symbol of self-reliance and rural employment. The **All-India Spinners' Association (1925)** organised it.
- **Other village industries** — hand-pounding of rice, hand-grinding of flour, palm gur, soap-making and tanning, to revive the rural economy alongside khadi.
- **Village sanitation** — clean water, drainage and everyday hygiene, treated as ordinary reform, not a hospital-only matter.
- **Nai Talim / Basic Education** — self-supporting education built around handicraft (हस्तशिल्प), adopted at the **Wardha Education Conference, 1937**.
- **Adult education** — literacy drives for villagers left out of formal schooling.
- **Uplift of women** — ending purdah excesses and child marriage, and drawing women into public work.
- **Health and hygiene education** — nature-cure ideas and basic health awareness carried into villages.
- **Propagation of Hindustani** as a common link language, written in both scripts.

- **Economic equality** — narrowing the gap between rich and poor, close to his **trusteeship** idea.
- **Service of kisans (peasants) and labour** — organising their welfare within a non-violent framework, not through class war.
- **Service of Adivasis and lepers** — groups Gandhi flagged as neglected even by other reformers.
- **Students** — keeping them linked to national work without abandoning study discipline.

> **Logic:** Constructive Programme is **daily nation-building work**, not a satyagraha. It is **not** the same as council entry — that was the Swarajists' method (13.9), not Gandhi's.

Vaikom Satyagraha (1924–25)

Place: Vaikom, Travancore (present-day Kerala) **Issue:** temple-road access and caste discrimination around the Vaikom Mahadeva temple **Years: 1924–25**

Cause

- Lower-caste Hindus were barred from using the public roads around the **Vaikom** temple in Travancore. Local reformers treated this as a test case of untouchability in everyday public space, not only inside the shrine.

Course

- A non-violent satyagraha began in **March 1924**, with volunteers attempting to walk the barred roads and courting arrest. Leaders from Kerala's social-reform and Congress streams organised relays of satyagrahis.
- **Mahatma Gandhi** (महात्मा गांधी) visited, backed the struggle, and pressed for disciplined non-violence and Hindu social reform rather than a purely political clash with the Travancore state.
- The campaign ran for many months, drawing all-India attention as the clearest early **temple-entry / anti-untouchability** satyagraha of the constructive decade.

Result

- Travancore gradually opened the approach roads; the satyagraha is remembered as a **success** for the anti-untouchability stream and as a dress rehearsal for later temple-entry campaigns.
- Do **not** confuse Vaikom with Gandhi's later **Harijan** tours or with the **Poona Pact (1932)** — Vaikom is a Travancore social satyagraha of **1924–25**.

> **Logic:** Vaikom = **1924–25 Travancore** temple-road satyagraha. Gandhi participated; UPPCS treats both the anti-untouchability aim and his participation as correct.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q150 (Vaikom)

In the contexts of Indian history (इतिहास), which of the following statement/s is/are correct regarding Vaikom Satyagraha?

1. It was a satyagraha against untouchability and caste discrimination.
2. Mahatma Gandhi participated in this Satyagraha.

A. 1 only

B. 2 only

C. Both 1 and 2

D. Neither 1 nor 2

Show answer

Ans: C

13.19 August Offer (August 1940)

Announced: 8 August 1940 Viceroy: Lord **Linlithgow Context:** Congress ministries had already resigned in 1939 over being dragged into World War II without consultation; the Muslim League's **Lahore session (March 1940)** had just passed the Pakistan resolution.

- The Offer proposed to expand the **Viceroy's Executive Council** with more Indians, set up a **War Advisory Council**, and grant **Dominion status after the war**.
- Crucially, it promised minorities (in effect, the Muslim League) a **veto** — no future constitution would be framed without their consent.
- **Congress rejected it**: dominion status "after the war" was vague, and a minority veto blocked real advance.
- The **Muslim League also rejected it**, because it fell short of a clear commitment to Pakistan.
- Its failure pushed Gandhi toward a **symbolic** protest rather than a mass movement, since Britain was fighting a war Congress did not want to sabotage outright.

> **Logic:** August Offer = **1940, Linlithgow**. Do not confuse with the **Cripps Mission, March 1942** — that full card is Topic 14's.

13.20 Individual Satyagraha (October 1940)

Launched: October 1940 First satyagrahi: Acharya Vinoba Bhave (**17 October 1940**, Pavnar) **Sequence:** 1st = **Vinoba Bhave**; 2nd = **Jawaharlal Nehru**; 3rd = **Brahma Datt** (classic UPPCS order)

Cause

- The **August Offer** (13.19) had just failed to satisfy either Congress or the League, but Gandhi did not want to embarrass Britain's war effort with a full mass movement while the outcome of World War II was still open.

Course

- Gandhi chose a **restrained, symbolic** protest: selected individuals, one at a time, publicly announced that it was wrong to help the British war effort with men or money, and then courted arrest.

- **Vinoba Bhave** was chosen as the **first satyagrahi**, signalling Gandhi's trust in his discipline; **Jawaharlal Nehru** was second; **Brahma Datt** is the classic third name in the UPPCS sequence.
- It was deliberately **not** a mass movement: no crowds, no all-India boycott campaign, no salt-style symbol — just disciplined individuals inviting arrest.

Result

- The protest kept the demand for freedom alive without embarrassing the Allied war effort, and continued into 1941, losing intensity as the international war situation changed.
- It served as a holding pattern until the deepening war forced Britain's hand, leading into the **Cripps Mission (1942)** and then **Quit India (1942)**, taught fully in **Topic 14**.

> **Logic:** Individual Satyagraha = **October 1940**, first satyagrahi **Vinoba Bhave** — not a mass CDM-style campaign. Continuity: WWII deepens after this into the **Cripps Mission (1942)** and **Quit India (1942)**, taught fully in **Topic 14**.

UP Focus

Fact	Detail
Chauri Chaura	**Gorakhpur**, 5 Feb 1922; NCM withdrawn
Ahmedabad / Kheda / Dandi	Gujarat satyagrahas; Dandi is Gujarat coast
Motilal / Swaraj Party	Allahabad Nehrus; Swaraj Party founded at Allahabad, Jan 1923
